

The government regulates the food industry so food is safe to eat and consumers can make informed choices about food.

We work with industry and other Australian Government agencies— particularly the [Department of Health and Aged Care](#) and [Food Standards Australia New Zealand](#) (FSANZ)—in developing [food regulation policy and domestic food standards](#) that:

- provides safe food controls to protect health and safety
- reduces the burden of laws and compliance on the food sector
- helps align Australia's and New Zealand's domestic and export food standards, and facilitate their harmonisation with international food standards
- provides cost effective compliance and enforcement arrangements for industry, government and consumers
- recognises that responsibility for food safety includes all levels of government
- supports the joint Australian and New Zealand efforts to harmonise food standards.

The food regulatory system

The Australia and New Zealand food regulatory system involves the Australian Government, Australian states and territories, and New Zealand. In this system, FSANZ develops food standards under the [Australia New Zealand Food Standards Code](#), which is enforced by state and territory governments in Australia.

Food standards are applied across the food supply chain—from paddock to plate—and cover:

- general food standards (including labelling requirements)
- specific food product standards
- food safety standards.

Australian and New Zealand food standards take into account domestic policy guidelines as well as [Codex Alimentarius](#) international food standards. We encourage industry and the community to participate in developing our [food regulatory policy](#) and [food standards](#).

Imported food

All [imported food](#) must meet Australia's biosecurity requirements (under the [Biosecurity Act 2015](#)) and food safety requirements of the [Imported Food Control Act 1992](#).

All food imported into Australia must comply with Australian food standards and requirements for safety. This includes compliance with:

We monitor imported food to check it meets these requirements through a risk-based inspection scheme called the [Imported Food Inspection Scheme](#).

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/agriculture-land/farm-food-drought/food/regulation-safety>